GA-05 | General Awareness (GA Capsule)

RRB JE CBT-2 (CEN 05/2025) — General Abilities | Weightage: 15 Questions

> **Exam angle:** RRB JE General Awareness mixes static GK (polity, history, geography, economy) with current affairs (2024–25), a strong Indian Railways component, science & tech in news, awards, and art & culture. This capsule is tuned to the exact topics seen in the 2025 CBT-2 paper, followed by a PYQ Corner, 30 practice MCQs, and rapid-revision material. Time-sensitive facts are marked with an as-of date.

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1. Indian Polity & Constitution

1.1 Constitution Basics

- The Constitution of India was adopted on **26 November 1949** and came into force on **26 January 1950**. **Dr B.R. Ambedkar** — Chairman of the Drafting Committee ("Father of the Indian Constitution").
- Longest written constitution in the world. Preamble declares India a **Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic**.
- Borrowed features: Parliamentary system & rule of law (UK), Fundamental Rights & judicial review (USA), Directive Principles (Ireland), Emergency provisions (Germany), Federal structure & residuary powers (Canada), Fundamental Duties (USSR).

1.2 Frequently-Asked Articles ★

Article	Provision
Article 14	Equality before law
Article 19	Six freedoms (speech, assembly, etc.)
Article 21	Right to life and personal liberty
Article 32	Right to constitutional remedies ("heart & soul" — Ambedkar)
Article 72	**President's power to grant pardons**, reprieves, remissions
Article 110	Defines a **Money Bill**
Article 123	**President's power to promulgate ordinances** when Parliament is not in session ★
Article 143	President can seek Supreme Court's advisory opinion
Article 226	High Courts' power to issue writs
Article 356	**President's Rule** (state emergency) in a state
Article 360	Financial emergency
Article 368	Amendment of the Constitution

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Under which Article can the President promulgate ordinances? → **Article 123** (ordinances have the force of law but must be approved by Parliament within 6 weeks of it reassembling). The Governor's equivalent is Article 213.

1.3 Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)

- Contained in **Part IV (Articles 36–51)**; borrowed from **Ireland**; **non-justiciable** (not enforceable in court) but fundamental in governance.

- **Dr B.R. Ambedkar called them a "novel feature"** of the Constitution; **Granville Austin** described the Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles together as the **"conscience of the Constitution."** DPSP have also been called the **"life-giving provisions"** / instrument of instructions.
- Aim: to establish a **welfare state** and social & economic democracy. Examples: equal pay for equal work, uniform civil code, promotion of village panchayats, protection of environment (Art 48A).

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Which part of the Constitution is described as the "life-giving provisions" / novel feature aiming at a welfare state? → the **Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV).**

1.4 President's Powers ★

- The **President is the constitutional head** of India (nominal executive); real power rests with the Council of Ministers headed by the PM.
- **Executive:** appoints PM, Governors, judges, CAG, etc.
- **Legislative:** summons/prorogues Parliament, **can dissolve the Lok Sabha** (on the advice of the Council of Ministers), gives assent to bills, nominates members.
- **Emergency powers:** National (Art 352), State/President's Rule (Art 356), Financial (Art 360).
- **Judicial:** grants pardons (Art 72).

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Who has the power to dissolve the Lok Sabha? → the **President of India** (Article 85), acting on the advice of the Council of Ministers. The Rajya Sabha is a permanent house and is **never** dissolved.

1.5 Parliament & Judiciary (Basics)

Body	Key facts
Lok Sabha	House of the People; max 552 members; term 5 years; can be dissolved
Rajya Sabha	Council of States; permanent house; 1/3 retire every 2 years; max 250
Supreme Court	Apex court; Chief Justice + up to 33 judges; guardian of the Constitution
High Courts	One for each state / group of states
Judicial Review	Courts can strike down unconstitutional laws

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2. Indian History Highlights

2.1 Ancient — Mauryan Economy & Guilds ★

- **Mauryan Empire (322–185 BCE)** founded by **Chandragupta Maurya** with **Chanakya (Kautilya)**, whose treatise **Arthashastra** describes the economy and administration.
- The Mauryan economy was highly organised: **artisans and craftsmen were organised into guilds called "shrenis"** (associations of people in the same craft/trade). Guilds regulated production, quality, prices and training, and were an important economic institution.
- **Ashoka** (grandson of Chandragupta) spread Buddhism after the Kalinga War; his edicts are inscribed on pillars and rocks.

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** In the Mauryan economy, artisans were organised into what? → **guilds (shrenis)** — craft/trade associations that regulated their occupation.

2.2 Freedom Movement — Key Events & Leaders

Year	Event
1857	First War of Independence (Sepoy Mutiny)
1885	Indian National Congress founded (A.O. Hume)
1905	Partition of Bengal → **Swadeshi Movement** (boycott of foreign goods, promote Indian goods)
1919	Jallianwala Bagh massacre; Rowlatt Act
1920	Non-Cooperation Movement (Gandhi)
1930	Salt March / Dandi / Civil Disobedience
1942	Quit India Movement ("Do or Die")
1947	Independence (15 August)

Swadeshi Movement: launched during the anti-Partition agitation of 1905; promoted Indian-made goods (**swadeshi**) and boycott of British products — this stimulated Indian industries.

2.3 Bengal Chemical & Acharya P.C. Ray ★

- **Acharya Prafulla Chandra Ray (P.C. Ray)** — pioneering Indian chemist, called the **"Father of Indian Chemistry."**
- He founded **Bengal Chemical and Pharmaceutical Works (1901, Kolkata)** — one of India's first indigenous pharmaceutical/chemical companies, embodying the swadeshi spirit of building Indian industry.

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Who founded Bengal Chemical and Pharmaceutical Works? → **Acharya P.C. Ray** (Father of Indian Chemistry), in 1901, a landmark of the swadeshi industrial movement.

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3. Geography of India

3.1 Physical Features

- The **Himalayas** run in a broad arc along India's northern border with a general **north-west to south-east (NW–SE) orientation.** Three parallel ranges: **Himadri (Greater), Himachal (Lesser), Shiwalik (Outer)**. Highest peak in India: **Kanchenjunga**.
- India lies between **8°4′N–37°6′N** latitude; the **Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N)** passes through 8 states.
- **Standard Meridian:** 82°30′E (passes through Mirzapur, UP).

3.2 Rivers & Famous Bridges ★

Bridge	River	Note
Dhola–Sadiya (Bhupen Hazarika Setu)	**Brahmaputra** (Lohit)	India's longest **road** bridge (9.15 km); Assam–Arunachal; opened 2017 ★
Bogibeel Bridge	Brahmaputra	Longest **rail-cum-road** bridge in India; Assam (2018)
Howrah Bridge (Rabindra Setu)	**Hooghly**	Kolkata; iconic cantilever bridge
Pamban Bridge	Palk Strait sea	Connects Rameswaram island to mainland Tamil Nadu; India's first sea bridge
Mahatma Gandhi Setu	**Ganga**	Patna, Bihar
Vidyasagar Setu	Hooghly	Kolkata; longest cable-stayed bridge
Atal Setu (MTHL)	Sea (Mumbai)	India's longest sea bridge, ~21.8 km (2024)

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** The Dhola–Sadiya bridge is built over which river? → the **Brahmaputra** (Lohit tributary), connecting Assam and Arunachal Pradesh; also called Bhupen Hazarika Setu.

Major rivers: Ganga (longest in India), Brahmaputra, Yamuna, Godavari (longest in South India, "Dakshin Ganga"), Krishna, Narmada & Tapi (west-flowing, into Arabian Sea).

3.3 National Parks — One Table

National Park	State	Famous for
Jim Corbett	Uttarakhand	India's oldest NP (1936); tigers
Kaziranga	Assam	One-horned rhinoceros (UNESCO site)
Gir	Gujarat	Asiatic lions
Sundarbans	West Bengal	Royal Bengal tiger, mangroves
Ranthambore	Rajasthan	Tigers
Kanha / Bandhavgarh	Madhya Pradesh	Tigers; MP = "Tiger State"
Periyar	Kerala	Elephants
Keoladeo (Bharatpur)	Rajasthan	Birds (wetland)

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4. Indian Economy

4.1 Sectors of the Economy ★

Sector	Meaning	Examples
Primary	Extracts natural resources	Agriculture, mining, fishing, forestry
Secondary	Manufacturing & industry	Factories, construction, **electricity/power generation** ★
Tertiary	Services	Banking, transport, IT, tourism, railways

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Electricity generation falls under which sector? → the **Secondary sector.** Although often listed with "utilities," in the standard three-sector classification electricity, gas and water supply are grouped under the **secondary (industrial)** sector because they involve processing/production, not raw extraction.

4.2 Banking & Budget Basics

Term	Meaning
RBI	Reserve Bank of India — central bank (est. 1935); issues currency, controls monetary policy
Repo rate	Rate at which RBI lends to commercial banks
CRR / SLR	Cash Reserve Ratio / Statutory Liquidity Ratio — funds banks must keep in reserve
Fiscal deficit	Excess of government expenditure over revenue (excluding borrowings)
Direct tax	Paid directly (income tax, corporate tax)
Indirect tax	On goods/services (GST) — **GST launched 1 July 2017**, "one nation one tax"
Union Budget	Presented on 1 February by the Finance Minister
NITI Aayog	Policy think-tank (replaced Planning Commission, 2015)

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5. Science & Technology in News

5.1 ISRO Missions ★

Mission	Year	Purpose
Chandrayaan-3	2023	India became the **1st country to soft-land near the lunar south pole** (Vikram lander, Pragyan rover)
Chandrayaan-2	2019	Orbiter success; lander lost
Chandrayaan-1	2008	Confirmed water molecules on the Moon
Mangalyaan (MOM)	2013	India's 1st Mars mission; 1st Asian nation to reach Mars orbit in first attempt
Aditya-L1	2023	India's 1st solar mission; studies the Sun from the L1 point
Gaganyaan	Upcoming	India's first human spaceflight programme *(as of 2024–25)*
PSLV / GSLV / LVM3	—	Launch vehicles; LVM3 (GSLV Mk III) is the heaviest

- **ISRO** — Indian Space Research Organisation, HQ Bengaluru; founder **Dr Vikram Sarabhai**; current Chairman **Dr V. Narayanan** *(from Jan 2025; succeeded S. Somanath)*.
- **DRDO** — Defence Research & Development Organisation; missiles: **Agni** (long-range ballistic), **Prithvi, BrahMos** (supersonic cruise, India–Russia), **Akash** (SAM), **Astra** (air-to-air). Mission Divyastra: MIRV test on Agni-5 (2024).

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6. Indian Railways — Special Section ★★

- **First train in India: 16 April 1853**, from **Bori Bunder (Mumbai) to Thane** (~34 km), hauled by locomotives Sahib, Sindh and Sultan.
- Indian Railways = one of the world's largest rail networks under a single management; HQ: New Delhi (Rail Bhavan); **"Lifeline of the Nation."**
- **Number of railway zones: 18** (plus special units like Kolkata Metro).

6.1 Railway Zones (Selected)

Zone	HQ
Northern Railway	New Delhi
Western Railway	Mumbai (Churchgate)
Central Railway	Mumbai (CSMT)
Eastern Railway	Kolkata
Southern Railway	Chennai
South Central Railway	Secunderabad
North Eastern Railway	Gorakhpur
South Coast Railway (newest)	Visakhapatnam

6.2 Railway Firsts & Modernisation

Item	Fact
First train	1853, Mumbai–Thane
First electric train	Deccan Queen (1930), Mumbai–Pune
Vande Bharat Express	India's first indigenous semi-high-speed train (2019); many routes operational *(as of 2025)*
Kavach	Indigenous **Automatic Train Protection (anti-collision)** system
DFC	Dedicated Freight Corridors — Eastern & Western, for freight-only trains
Fastest train	Vande Bharat / Gatimaan Express (Delhi–Jhansi)
Longest route	Vivek Express (Dibrugarh–Kanyakumari)
Bullet train project	Mumbai–Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail (with Japan)
Railway Minister	**Ashwini Vaishnaw** *(as of 2025)*

- Superlatives: **Longest platform** — Hubballi (Karnataka); **Longest tunnel** — Pir Panjal (J&K); **highest rail bridge** — **Chenab Bridge** (J&K), world's highest railway arch bridge, opened 2025.

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7. Sports

Award / Event	Detail
BCCI Naman Awards	Annual cricket awards; **Smriti Mandhana** won the **Best International Women's Cricketer** (Polly Umrigar equivalent for women) *(2023–24 season, announced 2025)* ★
Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna	India's highest sporting honour
Arjuna Award	For consistent outstanding performance
Dronacharya Award	For coaches
Paris Olympics 2024	India won 6 medals; **Neeraj Chopra** — silver (javelin); Manu Bhaker — 2 bronze (shooting)
Chess	**D. Gukesh** became the **youngest World Chess Champion** (Dec 2024)
Cricket	India won the **T20 World Cup 2024**

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Who won the BCCI Naman Award (best women's international cricketer)? → **Smriti Mandhana** *(as of the 2025 awards for 2023–24 season).*

8. Awards & Honours

Award	Recipients / Fact
Bharat Ratna 2024	Five conferred: **Karpoori Thakur (posthumous), L.K. Advani, P.V. Narasimha Rao (posthumous), Chaudhary Charan Singh (posthumous), M.S. Swaminathan (posthumous)**
Nobel Prize 2024	Peace: **Nihon Hidankyo** (Japan, anti-nuclear); Literature: **Han Kang** (South Korea); Physics: Hopfield & Hinton (machine learning/AI) *(as of 2024)*
Padma Awards	Padma Vibhushan > Padma Bhushan > Padma Shri (civilian honours)
Gallantry	Param Vir Chakra (highest wartime)

9. Art & Culture

9.1 Music — Bhatkhande Notation ★

- **Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande** — a great musicologist who **systematised Hindustani (North Indian) classical music** and developed the widely used **Bhatkhande notation system** to write down ragas and compositions. He organised ragas into the **10 Thaat** classification.
- **Vishnu Digambar Paluskar** — another reformer who developed his own notation system and popularised music education.

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Who developed a widely used music notation system for Hindustani classical music? → **V.N. Bhatkhande** (the Bhatkhande notation and the Thaat system).

9.2 Classical Dance Forms

Dance	State
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu
Kathak	North India (UP)
Kathakali / Mohiniyattam	Kerala
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh
Odissi	Odisha
Manipuri	Manipur
Sattriya	Assam
Bharatanatyam & the above form the **8 classical dances** recognised by Sangeet Natak Akademi	

9.3 Festivals (Sample)

Festival	State
Bihu	Assam
Pongal	Tamil Nadu
Onam	Kerala
Baisakhi	Punjab
Hornbill	Nagaland
Rann Utsav	Gujarat

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10. Important Persons — Revolutions

Revolution	Colour	Field	Father
Green Revolution	Green	Foodgrains (wheat/rice)	**M.S. Swaminathan** (India); Norman Borlaug (world) ★
White Revolution	White	Milk (Operation Flood)	**Verghese Kurien** ("Milkman of India", Amul)
Blue Revolution	Blue	Fisheries	Hiralal Chaudhuri
Yellow Revolution	Yellow	Oilseeds	Sam Pitroda (assoc.)
Pink Revolution	Pink	Meat/poultry	—

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Who is known as the Father of India's Green Revolution? → **M.S. Swaminathan** (agricultural scientist; introduced high-yielding wheat/rice varieties; awarded Bharat Ratna posthumously in 2024).

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11. Current Affairs 2024–25 Capsule

Topic	Key point *(as of 2024–25)*
Carl Zeiss GCC	German optics firm **Carl Zeiss** opened a **Global Capability Centre (GCC) in Bengaluru (November 2024)** — part of India's boom as a GCC hub ★
Global Capability Centres	India hosts 1,700+ GCCs; Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune are major hubs
G20 Summit	India hosted the **G20 Summit in New Delhi (2023)**; 2024 host: Brazil (Rio); 2025: South Africa
COP climate meets	COP28 Dubai (2023), COP29 Baku (2024)
Ram Mandir	Consecrated at Ayodhya, 22 January 2024
New Parliament	Inaugurated May 2023; **Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam** (Women's Reservation Act) passed 2023
Defence exercises	Malabar (India–US–Japan–Australia), Yudh Abhyas (India–US), Varuna (India–France), Tarang Shakti (2024, first multinational air exercise)
New CDS/appointments	Track latest Chief of Defence Staff, RBI Governor (**Sanjay Malhotra**, from Dec 2024), CJI (**Sanjiv Khanna** then B.R. Gavai in 2025)
Elections	18th Lok Sabha (2024) — NDA government; Narendra Modi PM for 3rd term

> **2025 CBT-2 asked:** Which company opened a Global Capability Centre in Bengaluru in November 2024? → **Carl Zeiss** (German optical/optoelectronics company).

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12. PYQ Corner — Actual RRB JE CBT-2 2025 Questions Solved

Q1. Under which Article can the President of India promulgate an ordinance?

→ **Article 123** (when Parliament is not in session; the ordinance has the force of law but must be approved within 6 weeks of Parliament reassembling).

Q2. Who has the power to dissolve the Lok Sabha?

→ The **President of India** (Article 85), on the advice of the Council of Ministers. The Rajya Sabha is a permanent house and cannot be dissolved.

Q3. Which part of the Constitution, called a "novel feature"/"life-giving provisions", aims at a welfare state?

→ The **Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV, Articles 36–51)** — non-justiciable guidelines for governance.

Q4. In the Mauryan economy, artisans and craftsmen were organised into what?

→ **Guilds (shrenis)** — trade/craft associations that regulated production, quality and training.

Q5. Who founded Bengal Chemical and Pharmaceutical Works?

→ **Acharya P.C. Ray**, the "Father of Indian Chemistry" (founded 1901, Kolkata), a swadeshi-era enterprise.

Q6. The Dhola–Sadiya (Bhupen Hazarika) bridge is built over which river?

→ The **Brahmaputra** (Lohit), linking Assam and Arunachal Pradesh; India's longest road bridge.

Q7. Who is regarded as the Father of the Green Revolution in India?

→ **M.S. Swaminathan.**

Q8. Electricity generation falls under which sector of the economy?

→ The **Secondary sector.**

Q9. Who developed a widely used notation system for Hindustani classical music?

→ **V.N. Bhatkhande** (Bhatkhande notation; Thaat classification).

Q10. Who won the BCCI Naman Award as best international women's cricketer?

→ **Smriti Mandhana** *(as of 2025).*

Q11. Which company opened a Global Capability Centre in Bengaluru in November 2024?

→ **Carl Zeiss.**

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13. Practice MCQs (30) — Answers at the End

1. The Indian Constitution came into force on: (a) 15 Aug 1947 (b) 26 Nov 1949 (c) 26 Jan 1950 (d) 2 Oct 1950
2. Article 123 deals with: (a) Money bill (b) President's ordinance power (c) Pardons (d) President's Rule
3. Article 356 relates to: (a) Financial emergency (b) President's Rule in a state (c) Ordinances (d) Money bill
4. The President's power to grant pardons is under Article: (a) 72 (b) 110 (c) 143 (d) 226
5. Directive Principles are contained in which Part of the Constitution? (a) III (b) IV (c) V (d) II
6. Who can dissolve the Lok Sabha? (a) PM (b) Speaker (c) President (d) Chief Justice
7. Which house of Parliament is never dissolved? (a) Lok Sabha (b) Rajya Sabha (c) Both (d) State Assembly
8. Mauryan craft guilds were called: (a) Nagaram (b) Shreni (c) Sabha (d) Samiti
9. The Arthashastra was written by: (a) Ashoka (b) Kautilya (c) Megasthenes (d) Bindusara
10. The Swadeshi Movement began after the: (a) 1857 revolt (b) Partition of Bengal 1905 (c) Jallianwala Bagh (d) Quit India
11. Bengal Chemical Works was founded by: (a) J.C. Bose (b) P.C. Ray (c) C.V. Raman (d) Homi Bhabha
12. The Himalayas generally run in which orientation? (a) N–S (b) E–W (c) NW–SE (d) NE–SW
13. The Dhola–Sadiya bridge spans the river: (a) Ganga (b) Hooghly (c) Brahmaputra (d) Godavari
14. Howrah Bridge is over which river? (a) Ganga (b) Hooghly (c) Damodar (d) Yamuna
15. Pamban Bridge connects the mainland to: (a) Rameswaram (b) Diu (c) Elephanta (d) Majuli
16. Electricity generation is classified under which sector? (a) Primary (b) Secondary (c) Tertiary (d) Quaternary
17. Banking and IT services belong to the: (a) Primary (b) Secondary (c) Tertiary (d) Public sector
18. GST was implemented in India from: (a) 2016 (b) 2017 (c) 2018 (d) 2019
19. Chandrayaan-3 landed near the Moon's: (a) North pole (b) South pole (c) Equator (d) Far side centre
20. Aditya-L1 is a mission to study the: (a) Moon (b) Mars (c) Sun (d) Venus
21. India's first train (1853) ran between: (a) Delhi–Agra (b) Mumbai–Thane (c) Kolkata–Howrah (d) Chennai–Vellore
22. Kavach is a railway: (a) Ticketing app (b) Anti-collision system (c) New train (d) Zone
23. How many railway zones does Indian Railways have? (a) 16 (b) 17 (c) 18 (d) 20
24. Smriti Mandhana won which award? (a) Khel Ratna (b) BCCI Naman best women's cricketer (c) Arjuna only (d) Dronacharya
25. M.S. Swaminathan is associated with the: (a) White Revolution (b) Green Revolution (c) Blue Revolution (d) Pink Revolution
26. Verghese Kurien led the: (a) Green (b) White (c) Yellow (d) Blue Revolution
27. The Bhatkhande notation system is used in: (a) Carnatic dance (b) Hindustani classical music (c) Folk theatre (d) Painting
28. M.S. Swaminathan was awarded the Bharat Ratna in: (a) 2019 (b) 2021 (c) 2024 (d) 2023
29. Carl Zeiss opened a GCC in Nov 2024 in: (a) Pune (b) Hyderabad (c) Bengaluru (d) Chennai

30. The 2024 T20 World Cup in cricket was won by: (a) Australia (b) England (c) India (d) South Africa

Answers: 1-c, 2-b, 3-b, 4-a, 5-b, 6-c, 7-b, 8-b, 9-b, 10-b, 11-b, 12-c, 13-c, 14-b, 15-a, 16-b, 17-c, 18-b, 19-b, 20-c, 21-b, 22-b, 23-c, 24-b, 25-b, 26-b, 27-b, 28-c, 29-c, 30-c

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14. Rapid-Revision Tables

14.1 Articles You Must Know

Article	Topic
72	President's pardons
110	Money bill
123	Ordinance (President)
356	President's Rule
368	Constitutional amendment

14.2 Bridges & Rivers

Bridge	River
Dhola–Sadiya (Bhupen Hazarika)	Brahmaputra
Bogibeel	Brahmaputra
Howrah / Vidyasagar	Hooghly
Mahatma Gandhi Setu	Ganga
Pamban	Sea (Palk Strait)

14.3 Revolutions & Fathers

Revolution	Person
Green (foodgrains)	M.S. Swaminathan
White (milk)	Verghese Kurien
Blue (fish)	Hiralal Chaudhuri

14.4 ISRO Missions

Mission	Target
Chandrayaan-3	Moon (south pole landing)
Aditya-L1	Sun
Mangalyaan	Mars
Gaganyaan	Human spaceflight

14.5 One-Line Current Affairs *(as of 2024–25)*

Item	Fact
Bharat Ratna 2024	Karpoori Thakur, Advani, Narasimha Rao, Charan Singh, M.S. Swaminathan
Carl Zeiss GCC	Bengaluru, Nov 2024
BCCI Naman	Smriti Mandhana (women)
World Chess Champion	D. Gukesh (2024)
Railway Minister	Ashwini Vaishnaw

End of GA-05. This completes the General Abilities General-Awareness cluster (GA-03 Computer, GA-04 Environment, GA-05 GA) for RRB JE CBT-2, Electronics & Allied group.